

Geo Strategic Significance of Pakistan

- What is Geo Strategy ?
- What is geo graphical description of Pakistan?

What is geo Strategy?

- Geo Means the earth and strategy means planning, tactics and policy.
- The term 'geo strategy' was first used by Fredrick L. Schuman in his 1942 article "let us learn our geopolitics."
- Many geo-strategists are also geographers, specializing in subfields of geography, such as human geography, political geography, economic geography, cultural geography, military geography and strategic geography.

Pakistan as a country

- Provinces
- Weathers
- Natural resources
- Mountains
- Rivers
- Deserts
- Lakes
- Vallies

Geo graphical view of Pakistan on world map



Geo graphical description of Pakistan

- It is located in South East Asia.
- 24.35 North and 37.05 North latitudes 61 East to 78 East longitude.
- Area – 7,96096 sq km.
- Khyber pass connects Pakistan and Afghanistan
- Khunjrab pass links Pakistan to china
- Pakistan and Iran border meet at Koh-i-Tuftan.

Neighboring countries

Neighbouring Countries

Direction	Country	Land Boundary / Sea Length	Historical Name of boundary
East	India	1650 Km	Raddcliffe line
West	Iran	900 Km	Gold Smith Line
North	China	600 Km	Sino-Pak border
North West	Afghanistan	2250 Km	Durand line (1893)
North West	Tajikistan (Wakhan Strip)	27 km	
South	Arabian Sea	700 Km	

Narrow strip of Wakhan that separates
Central Asia from Pakistan



Geo Strategic Importance of Pakistan

- Proximity of Great Power
- Gateway to Central Asia
- Significance as transit economy
- Important link to chain of Muslim Countries
- China's link to middle east
- Reduce Indian hegemony in Arabian sea and Indian ocean

1. Proximity of Great Powers

- Russia and china busy to give check to US Power in this region and in other region like middle east, Africa, north America, Europe and Far east asia.
- US interest in this region:
 - a. Security :
 - i. Policy of Pax-America in order to restrain world dynamics from uni-polarity to multi polarity.
 - ii. US interest in region to contain the Growing china, Nuclear Iran, and Terrorism connection with Afghanistan
 - b. Business :
 - To benefit from the market of india and central asia

2. Gate way to Central Asia

- Central Asia is the Center stage of new great games: western quest for resources oil and energy resources in Central Asia.
- Pakistan is located very close to the oil rich Middle eastern region and central Asian states.
- Pakistan can influence shipment of oil.
- Iran is struggling to export its surplus gas and oil to eastern countries, Qatar, Pakistan and Turkmenistan pipeline project highlight the position.
- In this scare energy world, Pakistan can provide access from energy efficient to energy deficient state.

3. Significance as a transit economy

- Land locked Afghanistan finds its ways through Pakistan for trade .
- China with its fastest economy growth rate of 9% GDP developing southern provinces because its own part is 4500 km away from Sinkiang (Chinese province) but Gwader is 2500 km away.
- Pakistan offers central Asian regions the shortest route of 2600 km as compared to Iran 4500 km and Turkey 5000 km.
- Gwader port with its deep water attracts the trade ships of China, central Asian region and south east Asian countries.

4. Important link in the chain of muslim countries

- Geographically , Pakistan is situated at the center of the Islamic countries of Africa and asia.
- It is linked to these muslim states through land and sea routes and thus not only its ideological background, but its geographical centrality necessities that its support the unity of Muslim world.
- Prior to the cessation of east Pakistan, it was the largest Islamic state and naturally was in the vanguard of the movement for Islamic unity.
- Even afterwards, it actively works for the mutual alliance and unity of the Muslims.

5. China's link to middle east

- Pakistan is the only direct and shortest link between china and middle east.
- Gulf states possessing 63% of world's oil reserves.
- In development of this link Pakistan plays an important role by making Gawder a fully functional port with support of china.
- Gawder will prove instrumental; in promoting transshipment essentially of containerized cargo besides unlocking the development potential for hinterland.

6. Countering Indian hegemony in Arabian sea and Indian ocean

- Indian has shared interest with US and NATO in subjection of Pakistan
- As they consider nuclear weapons of Pakistan as threat to Indian national security, NATO operations in Afghanistan and Israel.
- Pakistan have nuclear deterrence since 1998. Pakistan termed its nuclear bomb as ISLAMIC BOMB that made it centre of attention in world politics.
- The US, NATO Israel and India to neutralize such a strategic and tactical threat from emerging in Pakistan.

- They have made plan underpinned objective of Balkanizing Pakistan.\its reason on that the US has conspired with international media against PAK NUKES.
- Most importantly Pakistan has world best missile technology and perceived enemies capitals are in Pakistan range like.

Conclusion

- Stephan Cohn describes geostrategic importance of Pakistan in these words, “ While history has been unkind to Pakistan, its geography has been its greatest benefit. It has resource rich area in north west people rich in the north east.
- Pakistan is junction of South Asia, west Asia and central Asia, away from resource efficient countries to resource deficient countries. The world is facing energy crisis and terrorism. Pakistan is a route for transportation and front line state against terrorism.